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STUDENT HANDOUT

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Whose Image Is This?

Grades 5–8 · Religion

James Tissot (1836–1902), Brooklyn Museum

ADMIT ONE

NAME _____ DATE _____ CLASS _____

In Jerusalem, a few days before he died, Jesus was handed a silver coin and asked whether God's people should pay taxes to Rome. His answer is one of the most famous sentences ever spoken about money, power and God.

01 PART 1 Read the story

> *"Show me the coin used for paying the tax." They brought him a denarius, and he asked them, "Whose image is this? And whose inscription?" "Caesar's," they replied. Then he said to them, "So give back to Caesar what is Caesar's, and to God what is God's."*
>
> MATTHEW 22:19–21

Some people wanted to trap Jesus. If he said *pay the tax*, the crowd would be angry. If he said *don't pay*, the Romans could arrest him.

02 PART 2 Look closely at the coin



CASE 7 · MINISTRY AND PASSION

The Tribute Penny

COIN	Silver denarius of Tiberius
DATE	14–37 AD
REFERENCE	RIC I 30
SCRIPTURE	Matthew 22:21

The face is the emperor Tiberius. The inscription calls him *son of the divine Augustus*, and the reverse reads PONTIF MAXIM — *High Priest*. To a faithful Jew, the coin itself was a provocation.

ON THE COIN	WHOSE IS IT?
The face on the front	
The words around the edge	
The title *High Priest* on the back	

Fill in the table above: does each part of the coin belong to Caesar or to God?

PART 3

03 Whose image do I carry?

> *So God created mankind in his own image, in the image of God he created them; male and female he created them.*
>
> GENESIS 1:27

The coin belongs to Caesar because it carries Caesar's image. Genesis says you carry God's image.

Finish the sentence: **I carry God's image, so I belong to...**

PART 4

04 Give back to God

Name **two** things you could give back to God this week. One can be time, one can be a gift or a kindness.

PART 5

05 Draw your coin

Draw yourself as a coin. What image is stamped on you? What words go around the edge?



SHARE WITH YOUR FAMILY

Find a coin at home together. Whose face is on it? What do the words say? Then ask: *what does it mean that we carry God's image?*